Communist vision of proper morality and behavior. In June 1961, shortly after the Bay of Pigs invasion and the heightened demand for national unity and revolutionary closing of ranks, as well as the revolutionary leadership's warming relationship with the PSP and the Soviet Union, the magazine was forced to close its doors. "In one brief moment, the members of the literary supplement and the newspaper had been transformed from representatives of the Revolution into its enemies."[16]

Other Cuban writers suffered the same fate. One of the country's best-known poets, Heberto Padilla, objected to the demands on Cuba's intellectuals in his poem "In Hard Times." "During hard times," he wrote, referring to the official insistence that outside attack, and the danger of subversion, required heightened loyalty, "they" asked the writer to devote every part of his body to the cause. "They explained to him later that all these donations would be useless unless he also surrender his tongue," the poem continues.[17] When first published in 1968, his collection in which this poem appeared won Cuba's highest poetry prize. Three years later, however, Padilla was arrested. After a month he reappeared, to read a public confession of his counter-revolutionary errors.

Intellectuals worldwide, including some of the Revolution's most outspoken supporters, were outraged. Jean-Paul Sartre, Simone de Beauvoir, Italo Calvino, Gabriel García Márquez, and many others signed an open letter of protest. Some, like Sartre and de Beauvoir, became permanently disillusioned with the Revolution. Others, like García Márquez, maintained their support despite their criticism of the Padilla Affair. The Affair marked the beginning of the "quinquenio gris" or "gray five years." Padilla remained in Cuba for another nine years, although he did not publish again until he was allowed to leave and made his new home in the United States in 1980.

Cuban detective writer Leonardo Padura (b. 1955) perhaps exemplifies a new generation of Cuban authors. U.S. detective fiction in translation was immensely popular in Cuba prior to the Revolution. The first wave of post-revolutionary detective stories tried to recreate the genre to meet revolutionary goals: the villains were representatives of